

5.2 The sources, origins, physical and working properties of components and systems and their social and ecological footprint	To apply knowledge and understanding of the advantages, disadvantages and applications of the following components, in order to be able to discriminate between them and select appropriately.
	5.2.1 Sensors: - a light-dependent resistors (LDRs) (in topic 1) - b thermistor (in topic 1) - c moisture sensor - d piezoelectric sensor.
	5.2.2 Control devices and components: - a rocker switch (on/off) (in topic 1) - b resistors (in topic 1) - c push to make switch (PTM) - d micro switch - e reed switch - f variable resistors - g transistor (bipolar) - h microprocessor - i microcontroller/PIC - j relay.
	5.2.3 Outputs: - a buzzers (in topic 1) - b light-emitting diodes (LEDs) (in topic 1) - c loudspeakers - d motors.

SYSTEMS

Key idea	What students need to learn:
	5.2.4 Sources and origins – where components and systems are resourced/manufactured and their geographical origin: - a Russia, Saudi Arabia, United States: polymers from crude oil – acrylic, high impact polystyrene (HIPS), acrylonitrile butadiene styrene (ABS) - b China, Russia, USA – silicon - c China, Australia, Russia – gold - d Chile, China, Peru – copper - e Australia, Chile, Argentina – lithium - f China, Russia, Canada – aluminium - g China, Australia, USA – Rare Earth Elements (REEs) - h Philippines, Indonesia, Russia, Canada and Australia – nickel.
	5.2.5 The physical characteristics of each component and system: - a tolerances, ratings and values – resistor colour codes - b material selection for case construction – physical/working properties, sustainability, manufacturing processes.
	5.2.6 Working properties – the way in which each material behaves or responds to external sources: - a conductors, insulators – thermal, electrical - b polymers used for cases – durability, hardness, toughness, elasticity.
	5.2.7 Social footprint: - a relying on scarce and/or hazardous elements used in components and systems – cobalt, tantalum, lithium - b effects of using components and systems, including modern communications – mobile phones, computers, games consoles, social media networks.
	5.2.8 Ecological footprint: - a effects of material extraction and processing of elements - b effects of built-in obsolescence - c effects of use - d the effects of disposal of components and systems – toxicity of metals and polymers.

SYSTEMS

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